

Session 19: How to Generate Referrals

Key Points...

1. Referrals are usually thought of as a "nice tip" for a good job.
 - Most business owners consider Referrals to be a sort of "accidental tip" for a good job.
 - This mindset will cut the number of Referrals you get down by a factor of 5 or 10.
 - If you want Referrals, you must DESIGN a process that generates them - then use it.
2. Referrals are a powerful way to squeeze more out of your marketing.
 - You've already invested the time, effort, energy and money to get a Customer.
 - And who's the most likely person to know excellent potential Customers?
 - Exactly, your current Customer.
3. The Paddy Lund story:
 - How could you make interacting with your business feel more like interacting with a trusted friend?
4. Make referrals part of the relationship from Day 1.
 - Instead of waiting until after the transaction, begin my making referrals "part of the deal."
 - Explain that you rely on them, and that you're going to earn them.
 - Then plant the seed to start referring NOW.
5. Connect with customers during emotional "windows of opportunity."
 - During any complex transaction or relationship, there are emotional "windows of opportunity" to make a big impression.
 - Contact, call, visit - and offer something memorable if you can.
6. Give your customers stories to tell about your products & services.
 - Humans use stories to get attention, to bond, and to connect with each other.
 - Give your customers great stories to tell everyone - so they do it automatically.
7. Thank your customers when they do what you asked them to do
 - When someone sends you a referral, thank them!
 - You want to reward the behavior that you'd like to more.